

Habitica

Turning Everyday Goals into a Game

Theme

Open Innovation

Core idea

Make progress itself rewarding.

Focus

Consistency, motivation & accountability

Problem Statement

Knowing what to do is often easier than consistently doing it.

Everyday goals

Study every day
Exercise regularly
Read more

The friction

Initial motivation fades
Missed tasks accumulate
Systems get abandoned

The central question

How can everyday responsibilities become more engaging?

Goal



Task list



Motivation



Missed tasks



Less engagement



Abandoned
system

Existing Solutions & The Gap

To-do apps

Tasks, deadlines, reminders

Gap: limited motivation beyond completion.

Calendars

Scheduling and reminders

Gap: reminders do not necessarily create motivation.

Habit trackers

Habits and streaks

Gap: repetition can still lose engagement.

Productivity systems

Dashboards, projects, integrations

Gap: more organization ≠ more engagement.

Identified gap

Most systems focus on organizing work. Habitica focuses on making progress itself rewarding.

Proposed Solution

Treat everyday productivity as a role-playing game.

The shift

Instead of:

“I need to study for two hours.”

Think:

“Completing my study task progresses my character.”

The principle

The real-world task remains the objective.

Game mechanics add an immediate feedback loop around completing it.

Real-world task



Complete



XP / Gold



Character progression

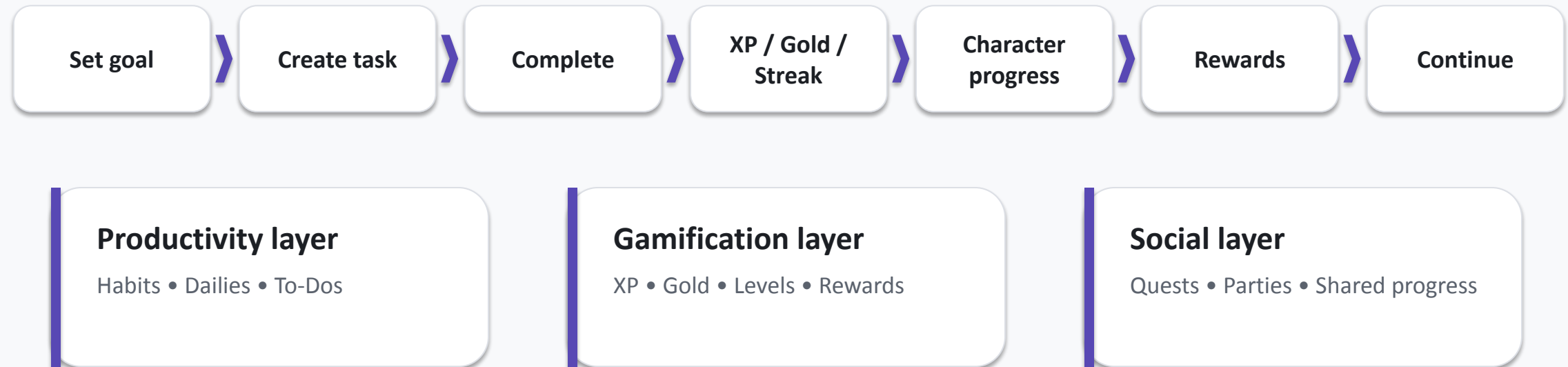


Rewards

Proposed Solution

The Productivity Loop

Immediate feedback connects today's action with longer-term progression.



Proposed Solution

Key Features

Habits

Track behaviors to encourage or discourage.

Dailies

Recurring activities on configurable schedules.

To-Dos

One-time or infrequent tasks.

Rewards

In-game and user-defined real-world rewards.

Progression

XP, Gold, levels, equipment and visible progress.

Streaks

Make consistency visible.

Quests

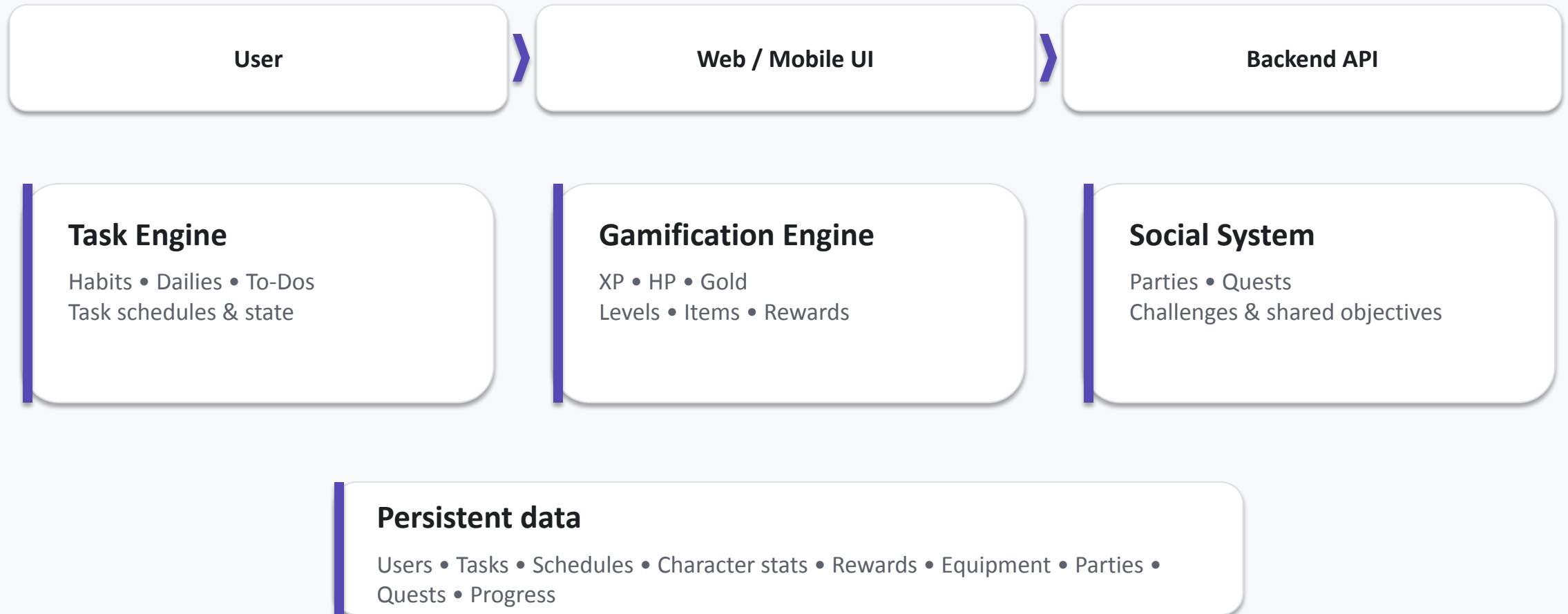
Turn individual progress into collaborative objectives.

Parties

Social accountability through shared goals.

Technical Approach

A full-stack system connects task activity to game state and social progress.



Technology Stack

Technology follows the requirements of the system.

Frontend

Vue / Vue.js — User interface

Backend

Node.js + Express — Runtime and API layer

Database

MongoDB — Persistent application data

Languages

JavaScript / HTML / CSS — Application development

API

Habituca API — External integrations

Clients

Android / iOS — Mobile access

Design principle

Problem → Requirement → Technology → Solution

Feasibility, Limitations & Impact

Feasibility

- Established full-stack technologies
- Clear task / gamification / social components
- Web and mobile clients
- Persistent data model and public API

Limitations

- Gamification may not work equally well for everyone
- Excessive gamification can become counterproductive
- Motivation remains dependent on individual behavior

Potential impact

- Students
- Habit builders
- Users who enjoy game mechanics
- Groups seeking accountability

Core value

Change the feedback loop: from “checkbox completed” to visible progress, rewards and continued engagement.

The Core Idea

A different question for productivity software.

Traditional approach

How can we make a better to-do list?

Task → Complete → Checkbox

Habitica's approach

What if completing real-world tasks produced the same sense of progression that makes games engaging?

Task → Complete → Feedback → Progress → Reward

Real-world goal



Task



Completion



Game feedback



Reward



Continue

Thank You

Questions & Discussion

(Team Name & Team Members)

Judge discussion

Why this problem? • Why this approach? • What are the trade-offs?